

## 8A\_Report\_Preferences

### 1 Preferences (All Dimensions)

**Takeaway:** On average, HR shows little demographic preference, while Engineers display a stronger preference for non-White groups over White Males.

|                                   | Panel A: HR (Non-blind, N = 66) |                  |                   |                     |                   | Panel B: Engineer (Non-blind, N = 74) |                    |                  |                     |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------|------------------|-------------------|---------------------|-------------------|---------------------------------------|--------------------|------------------|---------------------|
|                                   | sc_coding_z<br>(1)              | sc_fit_z<br>(2)  | sc_stay_z<br>(3)  | sc_overall_z<br>(4) | sc_advance<br>(5) | sc_coding_z<br>(6)                    | sc_fit_z<br>(7)    | sc_stay_z<br>(8) | sc_overall_z<br>(9) |
| White Female                      | 0.005<br>(0.084)                | 0.066<br>(0.087) | 0.055<br>(0.091)  | 0.017<br>(0.079)    | -0.017<br>(0.044) | 0.043<br>(0.049)                      | 0.015<br>(0.071)   | 0.029<br>(0.085) | 0.060<br>(0.052)    |
| Asian Male                        | -0.015<br>(0.081)               | 0.034<br>(0.092) | 0.117<br>(0.096)  | 0.003<br>(0.091)    | 0.003<br>(0.032)  | 0.144***<br>(0.047)                   | -0.015<br>(0.073)  | 0.050<br>(0.076) | 0.104**<br>(0.044)  |
| Asian Female                      | 0.018<br>(0.082)                | 0.075<br>(0.080) | 0.042<br>(0.092)  | 0.060<br>(0.081)    | 0.010<br>(0.034)  | 0.081<br>(0.050)                      | 0.163**<br>(0.065) | 0.117<br>(0.081) | 0.121**<br>(0.048)  |
| Hispanic Male                     | 0.174**<br>(0.087)              | 0.124<br>(0.087) | 0.169*<br>(0.086) | 0.152*<br>(0.084)   | 0.037<br>(0.038)  | 0.068*<br>(0.040)                     | 0.029<br>(0.055)   | 0.016<br>(0.066) | 0.096**<br>(0.039)  |
| Hispanic Female                   | 0.003<br>(0.097)                | 0.126<br>(0.105) | 0.055<br>(0.117)  | -0.048<br>(0.094)   | -0.011<br>(0.043) | 0.136***<br>(0.045)                   | 0.172**<br>(0.067) | 0.148<br>(0.094) | 0.165***<br>(0.050) |
| Observations                      | 1,188                           | 1,170            | 1,134             | 1,188               | 1,188             | 1,332                                 | 1,332              | 1,332            | 1,332               |
| R <sup>2</sup>                    | 0.41323                         | 0.31020          | 0.20001           | 0.43411             | 0.45460           | 0.81230                               | 0.57737            | 0.37778          | 0.76371             |
| Resume (Content) FE fixed effects | ✓                               | ✓                | ✓                 | ✓                   | ✓                 | ✓                                     | ✓                  | ✓                | ✓                   |
| Respondent FE fixed effects       | ✓                               | ✓                | ✓                 | ✓                   | ✓                 | ✓                                     | ✓                  | ✓                | ✓                   |
| Display Position FE fixed effects | ✓                               | ✓                | ✓                 | ✓                   | ✓                 | ✓                                     | ✓                  | ✓                | ✓                   |

Standard errors clustered by respondent.\ Significance levels: \* p<0.1, \*\* p<0.05, \*\*\* p<0.01

## 2 Heterogeneity in Preferences (By Respondent Demographics)

**Takeaway:** HR does not display preference based on demographic concordance. Engineers assign a slight premium (0.56–0.86% of a SD) to non-concordant groups, driven primarily by White Male Engineers — the majority group among Engineers — whose positive preference favors non-White demographic groups.

**Takeaway (2):** In the U.S. IT setting, the traditional concordance bias (homophily) and animus (discrimination against minorities) story can be rejected.

### 2.1 By Concordant Race (using detailed Asian categorization)

|                         | Panel A: HR (Non-blind, N = 66) |                  |                  |                     |                   | Panel B: Engineer (Non-blind, N = 74) |                   |                   |                     |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------|------------------|------------------|---------------------|-------------------|---------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------|---------------------|
|                         | sc_coding_z<br>(1)              | sc_fit_z<br>(2)  | sc_stay_z<br>(3) | sc_overall_z<br>(4) | sc_advance<br>(5) | sc_coding_z<br>(6)                    | sc_fit_z<br>(7)   | sc_stay_z<br>(8)  | sc_overall_z<br>(9) |
| Concordant Race         | 0.030<br>(0.056)                | 0.016<br>(0.058) | 0.064<br>(0.067) | 0.043<br>(0.060)    | 0.015<br>(0.021)  | -0.048<br>(0.030)                     | -0.063<br>(0.042) | -0.040<br>(0.054) | -0.061*<br>(0.032)  |
| Resume (Content) FE     | ✓                               | ✓                | ✓                | ✓                   | ✓                 | ✓                                     | ✓                 | ✓                 | ✓                   |
| Respondent FE           | ✓                               | ✓                | ✓                | ✓                   | ✓                 | ✓                                     | ✓                 | ✓                 | ✓                   |
| Display Position FE     | ✓                               | ✓                | ✓                | ✓                   | ✓                 | ✓                                     | ✓                 | ✓                 | ✓                   |
| Observations            | 1,080                           | 1,080            | 1,044            | 1,080               | 1,080             | 1,278                                 | 1,278             | 1,278             | 1,278               |
| Adjusted R <sup>2</sup> | 0.35325                         | 0.25633          | 0.11601          | 0.37576             | 0.40012           | 0.79632                               | 0.53838           | 0.31680           | 0.74254             |

Standard errors clustered by respondent.

### 2.2 By Concordant Gender (includes Male / Female respondents only)

|                         | Panel A: HR (Non-blind, N = 66) |                  |                   |                     |                   | Panel B: Engineer (Non-blind, N = 74) |                    |                   |                     |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------|------------------|-------------------|---------------------|-------------------|---------------------------------------|--------------------|-------------------|---------------------|
|                         | sc_coding_z<br>(1)              | sc_fit_z<br>(2)  | sc_stay_z<br>(3)  | sc_overall_z<br>(4) | sc_advance<br>(5) | sc_coding_z<br>(6)                    | sc_fit_z<br>(7)    | sc_stay_z<br>(8)  | sc_overall_z<br>(9) |
| Concordant Gender       | 0.042<br>(0.052)                | 0.044<br>(0.057) | -0.020<br>(0.066) | 0.023<br>(0.053)    | 0.007<br>(0.025)  | -0.013<br>(0.026)                     | -0.068*<br>(0.039) | -0.068<br>(0.060) | -0.056*<br>(0.032)  |
| Resume (Content) FE     | ✓                               | ✓                | ✓                 | ✓                   | ✓                 | ✓                                     | ✓                  | ✓                 | ✓                   |
| Respondent FE           | ✓                               | ✓                | ✓                 | ✓                   | ✓                 | ✓                                     | ✓                  | ✓                 | ✓                   |
| Display Position FE     | ✓                               | ✓                | ✓                 | ✓                   | ✓                 | ✓                                     | ✓                  | ✓                 | ✓                   |
| Observations            | 1,134                           | 1,116            | 1,080             | 1,134               | 1,134             | 1,278                                 | 1,278              | 1,278             | 1,278               |
| Adjusted R <sup>2</sup> | 0.36354                         | 0.25838          | 0.12807           | 0.37974             | 0.40982           | 0.78872                               | 0.55103            | 0.32234           | 0.73762             |

Standard errors clustered by respondent.

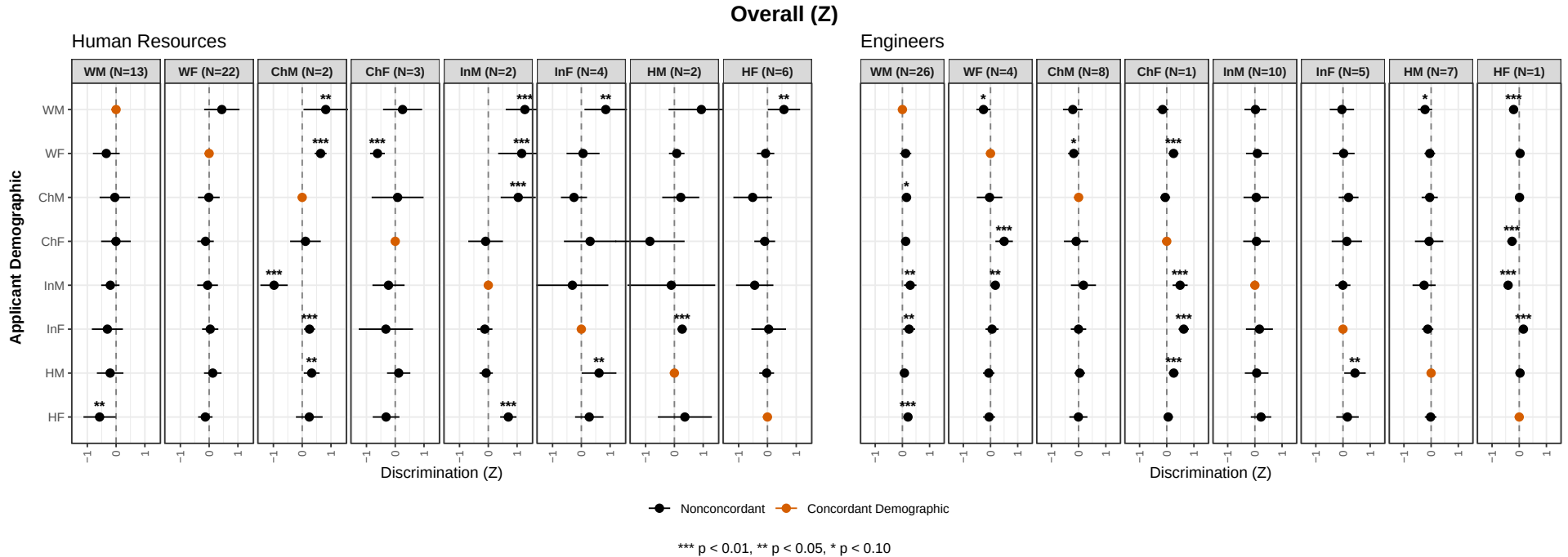
## 2.3 By Concordant Race and Gender (using detailed Asian categorization)

|                                | Panel A: HR (Non-blind, N = 66) |                   |                   |                     |                   | Panel B: Engineer (Non-blind, N = 74) |                   |                   |                     |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------|---------------------|-------------------|---------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------|---------------------|
|                                | sc_coding_z<br>(1)              | sc_fit_z<br>(2)   | sc_stay_z<br>(3)  | sc_overall_z<br>(4) | sc_advance<br>(5) | sc_coding_z<br>(6)                    | sc_fit_z<br>(7)   | sc_stay_z<br>(8)  | sc_overall_z<br>(9) |
| Concordant Race Gender         | 0.032<br>(0.075)                | -0.020<br>(0.080) | -0.021<br>(0.101) | 0.084<br>(0.080)    | -0.008<br>(0.037) | -0.051<br>(0.035)                     | -0.071<br>(0.058) | -0.088<br>(0.072) | -0.087**<br>(0.038) |
| Resume (Content) FE            | ✓                               | ✓                 | ✓                 | ✓                   | ✓                 | ✓                                     | ✓                 | ✓                 | ✓                   |
| Respondent FE                  | ✓                               | ✓                 | ✓                 | ✓                   | ✓                 | ✓                                     | ✓                 | ✓                 | ✓                   |
| Display Position FE (by three) | ✓                               | ✓                 | ✓                 | ✓                   | ✓                 | ✓                                     | ✓                 | ✓                 | ✓                   |
| Observations                   | 972                             | 972               | 936               | 972                 | 972               | 1,116                                 | 1,116             | 1,116             | 1,116               |
| Adjusted R <sup>2</sup>        | 0.34291                         | 0.25475           | 0.14292           | 0.37114             | 0.38470           | 0.81484                               | 0.59818           | 0.35538           | 0.75616             |

Standard errors clustered by respondent.

### 2.3.1 Who drives Engineers' Bias Against Concordant Race Gender Groups

Below graph centers the concordant group.



### 3 Heterogeneity in Preferences (By Respondent DEI / Diversity Preferences)

**Takeaway:** No individual DEI / diversity preference measure — stated, revealed, or firm-level — explains variation in demographic discrimination.

#### 3.1 (2-way Interaction Models) By Individual DEI / Diversity Variables

Standard errors clustered by respondent. Sample: non-blind arm.

**Reproduction with two DEI / Diversity Index Options.** The same regression as above, replacing the six individual DEI proxies with two composite indices: *Index A: Stated* — the four-item average of stated DEI views (existing `pro_dei_index_z`); *Index B: Stated + Revealed* — equal-weight composite of Index A and the revealed-priority ranking of “Diversity and Representation” from the goals question.

| <b>Outcome Var: Assigned Overall Score (Z) — Two DEI / Diversity Index Options</b> |                    |                    |                          |                     |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|--------------------|--------------------------|---------------------|
|                                                                                    | <b>Panel A: HR</b> |                    | <b>Panel B: Engineer</b> |                     |
|                                                                                    | Index A<br>(1)     | Index B<br>(2)     | Index A<br>(3)           | Index B<br>(4)      |
| White Female                                                                       | 0.043<br>(0.075)   | 0.043<br>(0.075)   | 0.060<br>(0.052)         | 0.060<br>(0.052)    |
| Asian Male                                                                         | 0.028<br>(0.092)   | 0.027<br>(0.092)   | 0.104**<br>(0.044)       | 0.103**<br>(0.044)  |
| Asian Female                                                                       | 0.086<br>(0.076)   | 0.086<br>(0.076)   | 0.121**<br>(0.048)       | 0.121**<br>(0.048)  |
| Hispanic Male                                                                      | 0.170**<br>(0.082) | 0.169**<br>(0.082) | 0.096**<br>(0.038)       | 0.096**<br>(0.038)  |
| Hispanic Female                                                                    | 0.001<br>(0.083)   | -0.001<br>(0.083)  | 0.167***<br>(0.050)      | 0.167***<br>(0.050) |
| White Female × DEI Index                                                           | 0.121<br>(0.098)   | 0.122<br>(0.096)   | -0.034<br>(0.070)        | -0.031<br>(0.071)   |
| Asian Male × DEI Index                                                             | 0.115<br>(0.112)   | 0.113<br>(0.111)   | -0.007<br>(0.040)        | -0.004<br>(0.039)   |
| Asian Female × DEI Index                                                           | 0.103<br>(0.108)   | 0.102<br>(0.106)   | 0.016<br>(0.045)         | 0.017<br>(0.045)    |
| Hispanic Male × DEI Index                                                          | 0.082<br>(0.109)   | 0.080<br>(0.107)   | 0.078*<br>(0.042)        | 0.074*<br>(0.042)   |
| Hispanic Female × DEI Index                                                        | 0.252*<br>(0.132)  | 0.247*<br>(0.130)  | -0.030<br>(0.056)        | -0.031<br>(0.056)   |
| Resume FE                                                                          | ✓                  | ✓                  | ✓                        | ✓                   |
| Respondent FE                                                                      | ✓                  | ✓                  | ✓                        | ✓                   |
| Position FE                                                                        | ✓                  | ✓                  | ✓                        | ✓                   |
| Observations                                                                       | 1,188              | 1,188              | 1,332                    | 1,332               |
| Adjusted R <sup>2</sup>                                                            | 0.38246            | 0.38240            | 0.74243                  | 0.74231             |

Index A is the existing four-item average of stated DEI views. Index B averages Index A with the respondent’s revealed-priority ranking of “Diversity and Representation” from the seven-goals question.

Reproduction (URM cut) with three DEI / Diversity Index Options.

| Outcome Var: Assigned Overall Score (Z) — URM Cut, Two DEI / Diversity Index Options |                  |                  |                    |                    |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|------------------|--------------------|--------------------|
|                                                                                      | Panel A: HR      |                  | Panel B: Engineer  |                    |
|                                                                                      | Index A<br>(1)   | Index B<br>(2)   | Index A<br>(3)     | Index B<br>(4)     |
| URM (WF, AF, HM, HF)                                                                 | 0.065<br>(0.051) | 0.064<br>(0.051) | 0.059**<br>(0.029) | 0.059**<br>(0.029) |
| URM $\times$ DEI Index                                                               | 0.077<br>(0.068) | 0.077<br>(0.066) | 0.016<br>(0.034)   | 0.014<br>(0.035)   |
| Resume FE                                                                            | ✓                | ✓                | ✓                  | ✓                  |
| Respondent FE                                                                        | ✓                | ✓                | ✓                  | ✓                  |
| Position FE                                                                          | ✓                | ✓                | ✓                  | ✓                  |
| Observations                                                                         | 1,188            | 1,188            | 1,332              | 1,332              |
| Adjusted R <sup>2</sup>                                                              | 0.37929          | 0.37932          | 0.74081            | 0.74080            |

URM-Tech = {White Female, Asian Female, Hispanic Male, Hispanic Female}. Standard errors clustered by respondent. Sample: non-blind arm.

### 3.2 (2-way Interaction Models) By Whether the Firm Targets the Same Applicant Demographic

**Takeaway:** When a firm states it targets a demographic, its individual evaluators rate applicants of that group *lower*, not higher — more strongly among engineers than among HR. This mirrors the substitution pattern documented in Section 3.3: where institutional DEI effort is high, individual evaluators appear to ease off from the institutional push.

| <b>Firm Targets × Same Applicant Demographic (s5_policy_diversity)</b> |                     |                          |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|--------------------------|
|                                                                        | <b>Panel A: HR</b>  | <b>Panel B: Engineer</b> |
|                                                                        | (1)                 | (2)                      |
| White Female                                                           | -0.048<br>(0.095)   | 0.084<br>(0.051)         |
| Asian Male                                                             | 0.005<br>(0.092)    | 0.112**<br>(0.045)       |
| Asian Female                                                           | 0.003<br>(0.091)    | 0.153***<br>(0.051)      |
| Hispanic Male                                                          | 0.157*<br>(0.085)   | 0.109***<br>(0.040)      |
| Hispanic Female                                                        | -0.107<br>(0.113)   | 0.201***<br>(0.049)      |
| Applicant Male × Firm Targets Male                                     | -0.206**<br>(0.098) | -0.003<br>(0.106)        |
| Applicant Female × Firm Targets Female                                 | 0.095<br>(0.236)    | -0.348**<br>(0.174)      |
| Applicant Asian × Firm Targets Asian                                   | -0.151*<br>(0.084)  | -0.261**<br>(0.099)      |
| Applicant Hispanic × Firm Targets Hispanic                             | -0.034<br>(0.142)   | -0.209**<br>(0.100)      |
| Resume FE                                                              | ✓                   | ✓                        |
| Respondent FE                                                          | ✓                   | ✓                        |
| Position FE                                                            | ✓                   | ✓                        |
| Observations                                                           | 1,188               | 1,332                    |
| Adjusted R <sup>2</sup>                                                | 0.38011             | 0.74387                  |

| <b>URM-Tech Binary Cut × Firm Targets (Female OR Hispanic)</b> |                    |                          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|--------------------------|
|                                                                | <b>Panel A: HR</b> | <b>Panel B: Engineer</b> |
|                                                                | (1)                | (2)                      |
| URM (WF, AF, HM, HF)                                           | 0.013<br>(0.060)   | 0.070**<br>(0.029)       |
| URM × Firm Targets URM                                         | 0.170<br>(0.160)   | -0.160<br>(0.111)        |
| Resume FE                                                      | ✓                  | ✓                        |
| Respondent FE                                                  | ✓                  | ✓                        |
| Position FE                                                    | ✓                  | ✓                        |
| Observations                                                   | 1,188              | 1,332                    |
| Adjusted R <sup>2</sup>                                        | 0.37901            | 0.74114                  |

F = Female, H = Hispanic, B = Black. “Targets F or H” ⇒ `firm_targets_female` = 1 OR `firm_targets_hispanic` = 1; “Targets F, H, or B” additionally includes `firm_targets_black` = 1 (robustness check; note that Black applicants are not in the study). URM = {WF, AF, HM, HF}.

### 3.3 (Triple Interaction Models) By Respondent’s Priority for DEI $\times$ Firm Attention on DEI

**Takeaway:** The negative triple interactions for HR (with both race-DEI and gender-DEI firm-attention proxies) support the **substitution** hypothesis, not backlash.

**Hypothesis:** Substitution vs. Backlash Effect.

- **Substitution:** When a firm already prioritizes DEI, individuals who *also* personally prioritize DEI reduce (rather than amplify) the URM premium — they treat the firm’s push as sufficient and ease off. *Expect a negative sign on the triple interaction term.*
- **Backlash:** When a firm prioritizes DEI, individuals who do *not* personally prioritize DEI react by rating URM applicants lower. *Expect a positive sign on the triple interaction term.*

`div_priority_z` = z-score of  $(8 - \text{s4\_goals\_5})$ , the revealed priority of “Diversity and Representation” in the respondent’s ranking of seven hiring goals. `firm_attention_race_z` / `firm_attention_gender_z` = z-scores of `s5\_view\_dei\_race\_f` / `s5\_view\_dei\_gender\_f`, the respondent’s perception of their firm’s current DEI attention level. Standard errors clustered by respondent. Sample: non-blind arm; respondents with a missing firm-DEI-attention response are dropped by `feols` (see the `Respondents (used)'' andDropped (NA proxy)''` rows).

*Note on interpretation:* On the full non-blind Engineer sample (all 74 respondents), a two-way model `sc_overall_z ~ urm_tech | responseid + resume_index + r_do_bythree` reports a statistically significant  $\hat{\beta}_{\text{URM}} = +0.060$  ( $p = .041$ ). It attenuates to statistically insignificant  $\hat{\beta} \approx +0.040$  in the triple-model subsample for two reasons: (a)  $\approx 18\%$  of Engineers are dropped due to answering “Do Not Know’’ in the question that elicits how much firm pays attentions to DEI, and (b) these dropped respondents happen to rate URM applicants more favorably than respondents who did characterize their firm’s DEI posture.



**Reproduction with three DEI / Diversity Index Options.** The same triple-interaction structure as above, but replacing the single revealed-priority variable (`div_priority_z`) with each of three composite DEI indices in turn. One sub-table per index.

| Index A                         |                      |                   |
|---------------------------------|----------------------|-------------------|
|                                 | Firm DEI Attn Lvl    |                   |
|                                 | HR                   | Eng               |
|                                 | (1)                  | (2)               |
| URM (WF, AF, HM, HF)            | 0.153**<br>(0.058)   | 0.019<br>(0.030)  |
| URM × DEI Index                 | 0.118**<br>(0.058)   | 0.072<br>(0.049)  |
| URM × Firm DEI Attn             | 0.071<br>(0.079)     | -0.034<br>(0.036) |
| URM × DEI Index × Firm DEI Attn | -0.320***<br>(0.099) | 0.031<br>(0.034)  |
| Resume FE                       | ✓                    | ✓                 |
| Respondent FE                   | ✓                    | ✓                 |
| Position FE                     | ✓                    | ✓                 |
| Observations                    | 1,008                | 1,080             |
| Adjusted R <sup>2</sup>         | 0.37877              | 0.74760           |

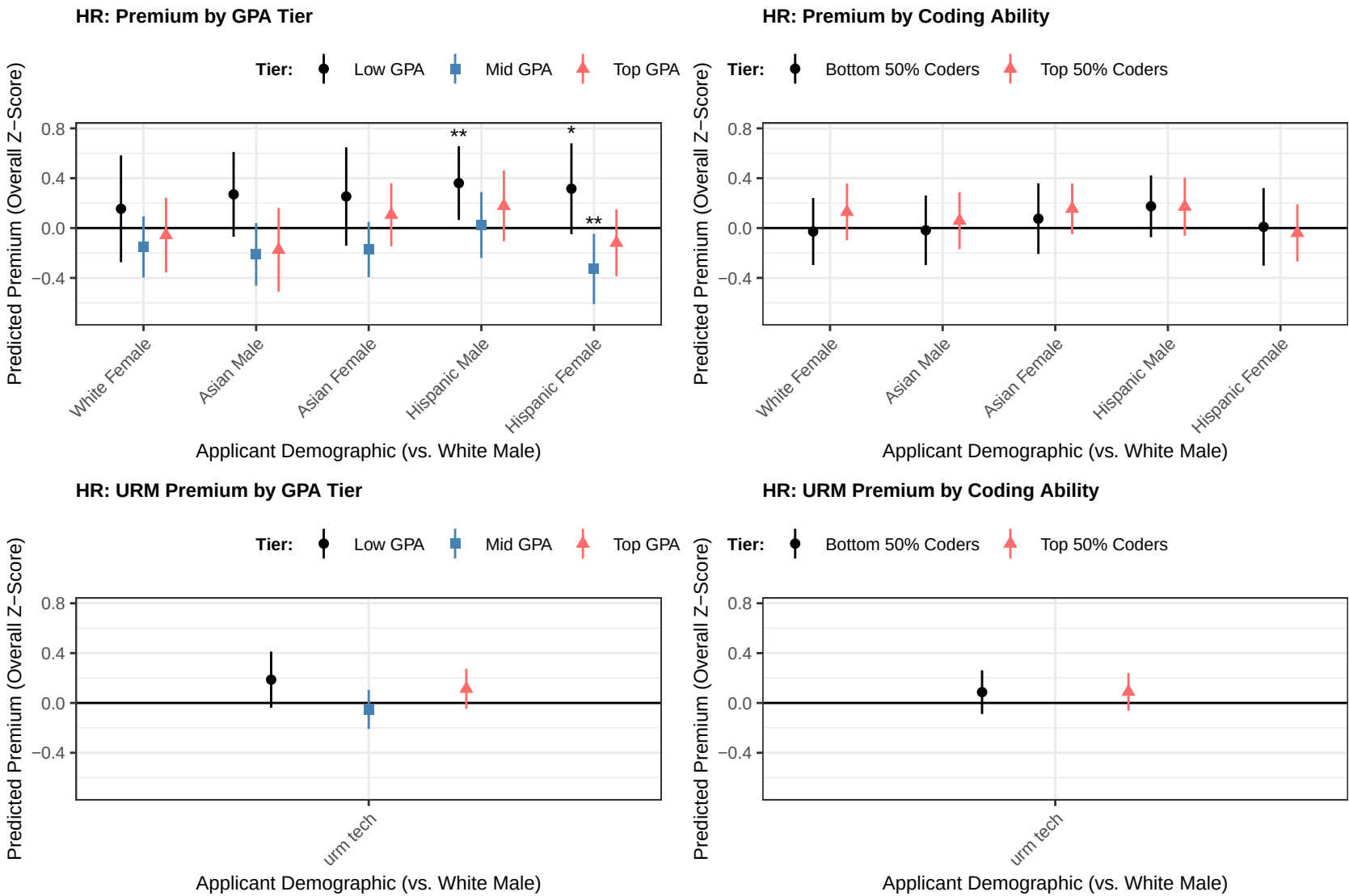
  

| Index B                         |                      |                   |
|---------------------------------|----------------------|-------------------|
|                                 | Firm DEI Attn Lvl    |                   |
|                                 | HR                   | Eng               |
|                                 | (1)                  | (2)               |
| URM (WF, AF, HM, HF)            | 0.153**<br>(0.058)   | 0.018<br>(0.030)  |
| URM × DEI Index                 | 0.114**<br>(0.056)   | 0.070<br>(0.052)  |
| URM × Firm DEI Attn             | 0.088<br>(0.084)     | -0.034<br>(0.036) |
| URM × DEI Index × Firm DEI Attn | -0.324***<br>(0.100) | 0.033<br>(0.034)  |
| Resume FE                       | ✓                    | ✓                 |
| Respondent FE                   | ✓                    | ✓                 |
| Position FE                     | ✓                    | ✓                 |
| Observations                    | 1,008                | 1,080             |
| Adjusted R <sup>2</sup>         | 0.37895              | 0.74759           |

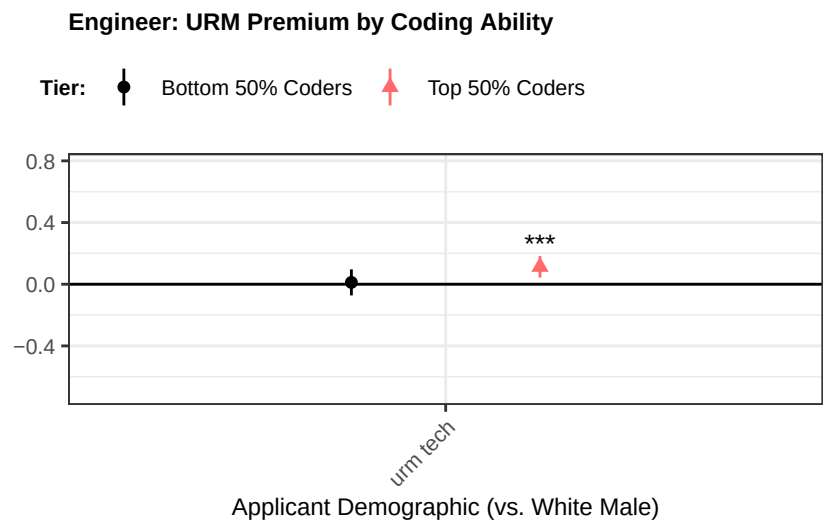
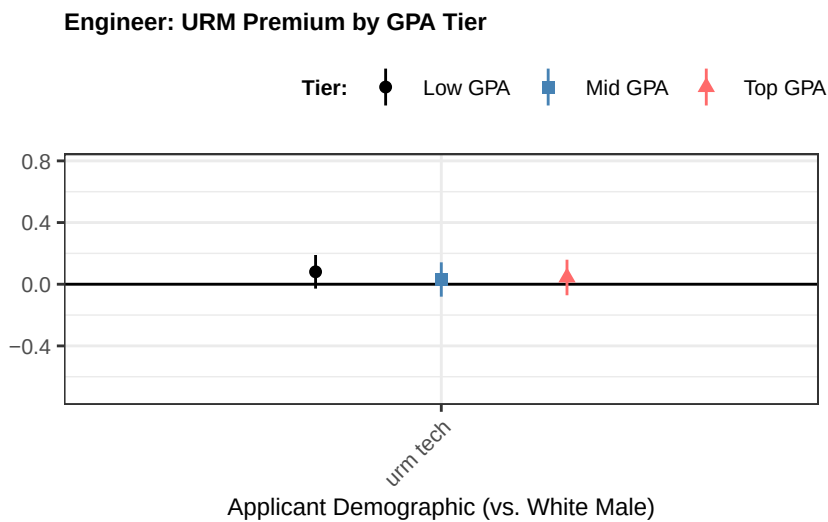
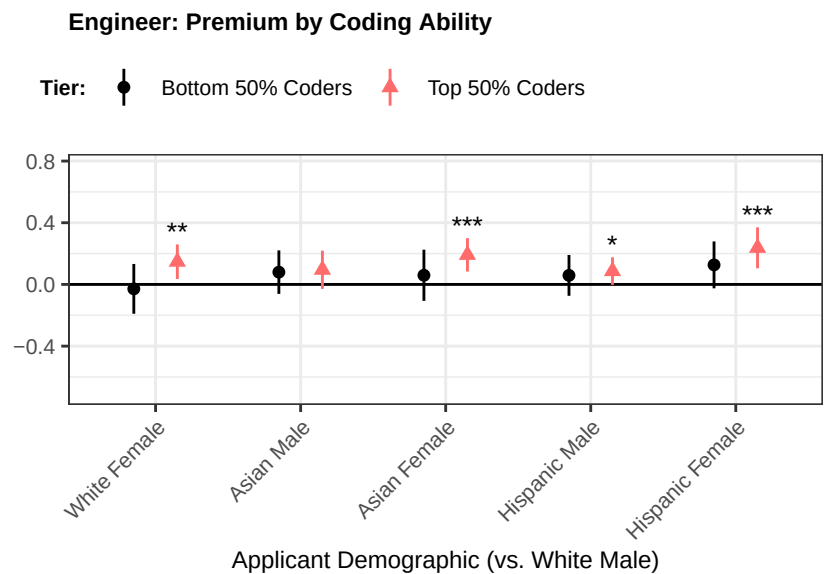
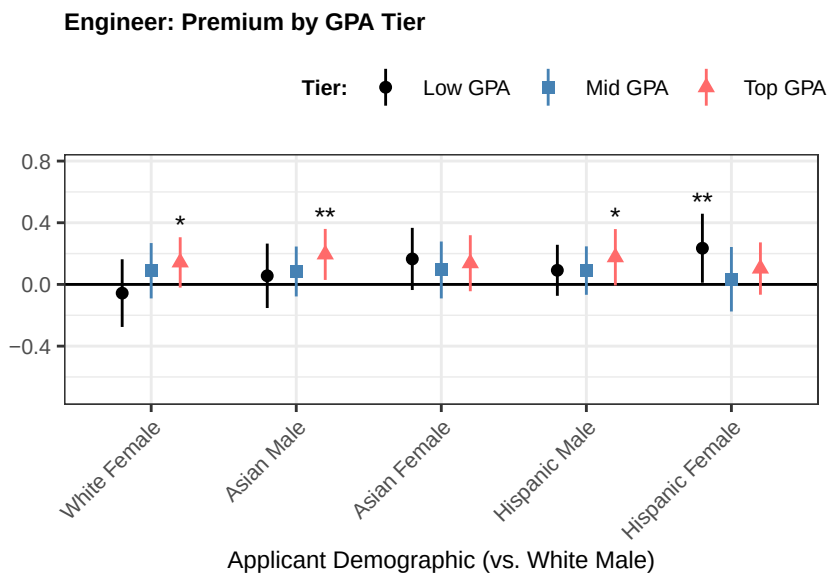
Three sub-tables, one per DEI index. Each sub-table reports HR vs. Eng under the combined firm-DEI-attention-level proxy (`firm_dei_attention_z`, the within-cell z-score of the equal-weight average of `firm_attention_race_z` and `firm_attention_gender_z`). The triple-interaction row tests the substitution-vs-backlash hypothesis with each index's notion of personal DEI alignment. Standard errors clustered by respondent. Sample: non-blind arm.

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3.3.0.1 HR



3.3.0.2 Engineer

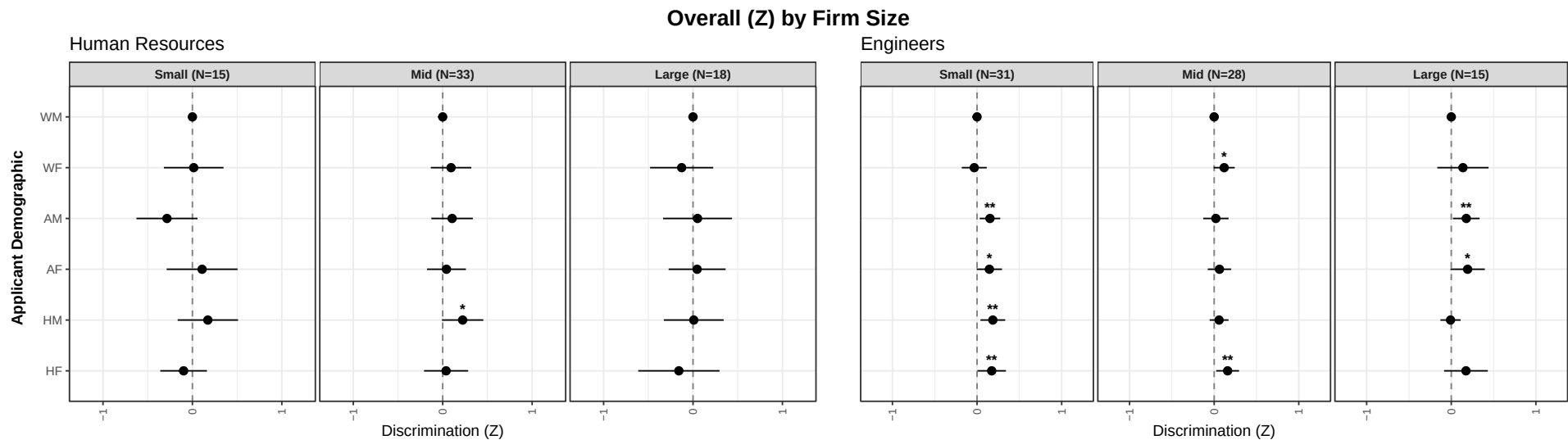


(Eng) Signal from GPA vs Coding Test

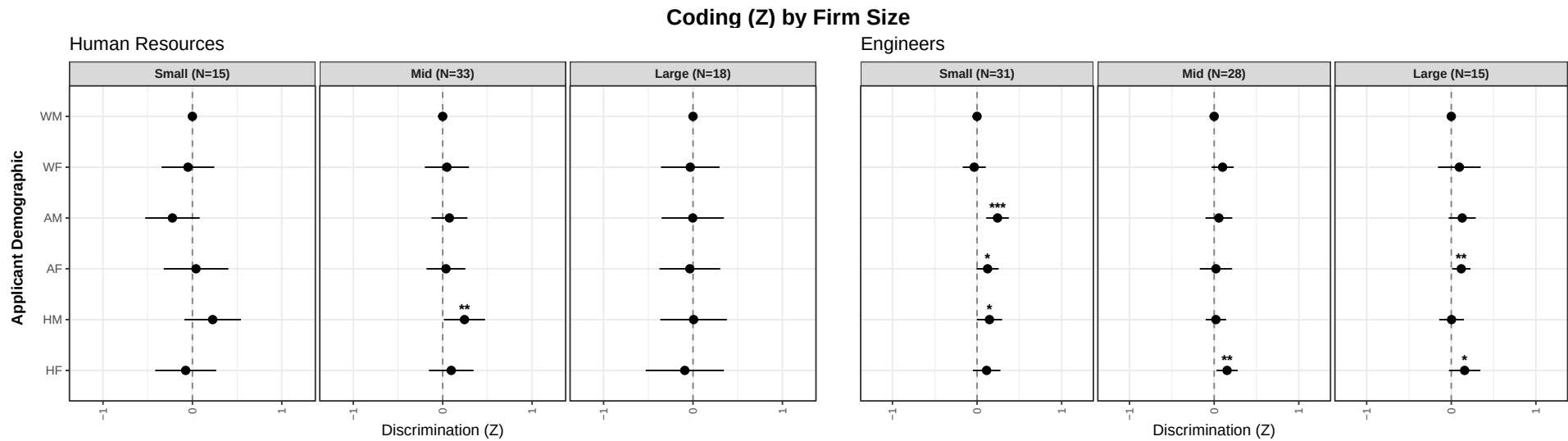
|                               | sc_overall_z<br>(1) |
|-------------------------------|---------------------|
| URM                           | 0.058**<br>(0.029)  |
| URM $\times$ Coding Score (Z) | 0.094**<br>(0.040)  |
| URM $\times$ GPA (Z)          | -0.094**<br>(0.044) |
| Observations                  | 1,332               |
| Adjusted R <sup>2</sup>       | 0.74227             |
| Resume FE                     | ✓                   |
| Respondent FE                 | ✓                   |
| Position FE                   | ✓                   |

Standard errors clustered by respondent. Sample restricted to non-blind condition, Engineer role.

3.4 Heterogeneity by Firm Size

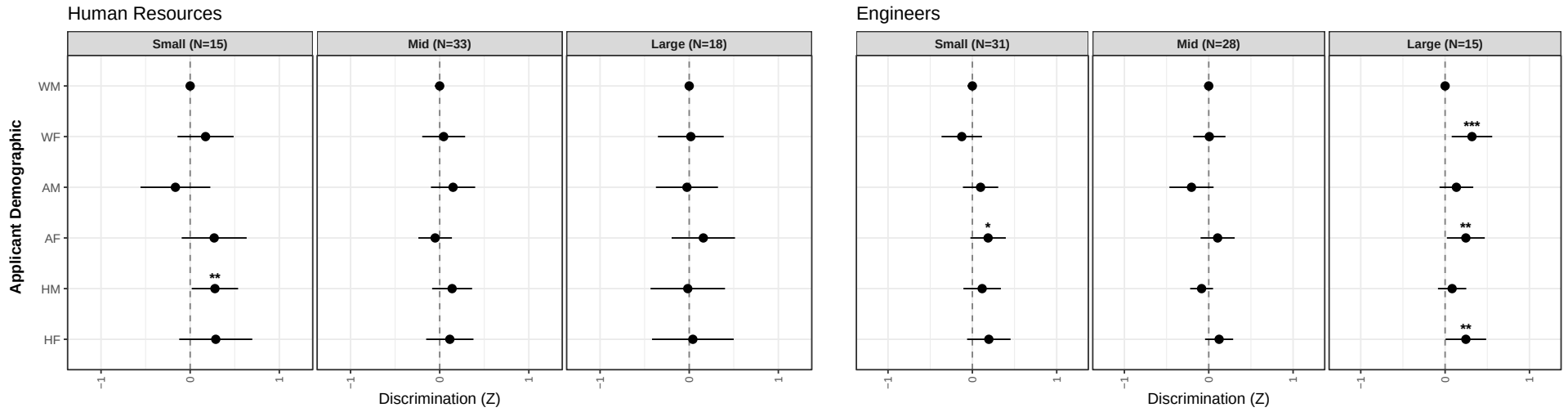


\*\*\* p < 0.01, \*\* p < 0.05, \* p < 0.10

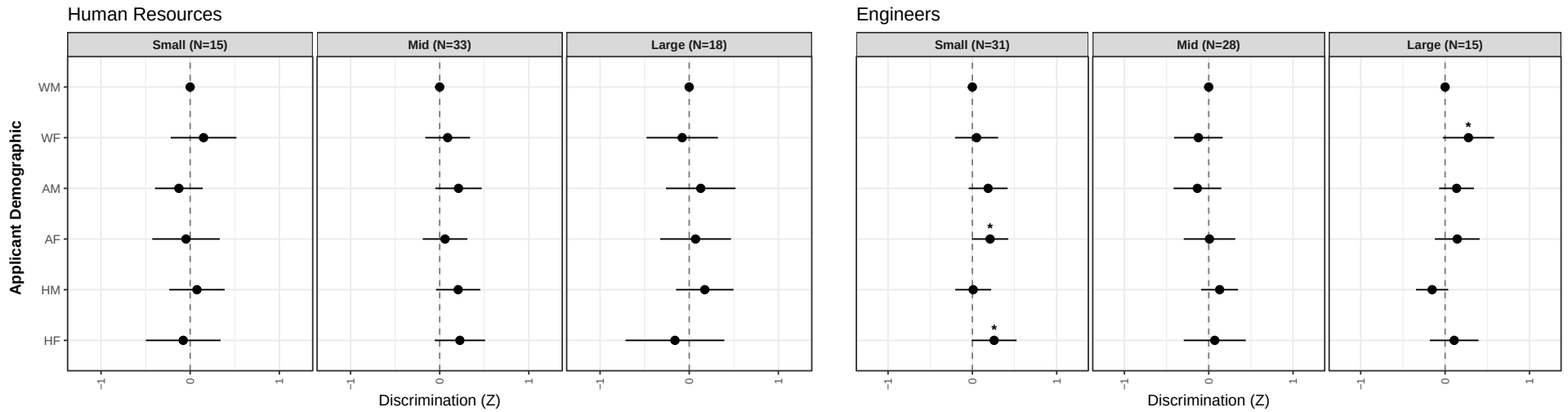


\*\*\* p < 0.01, \*\* p < 0.05, \* p < 0.10

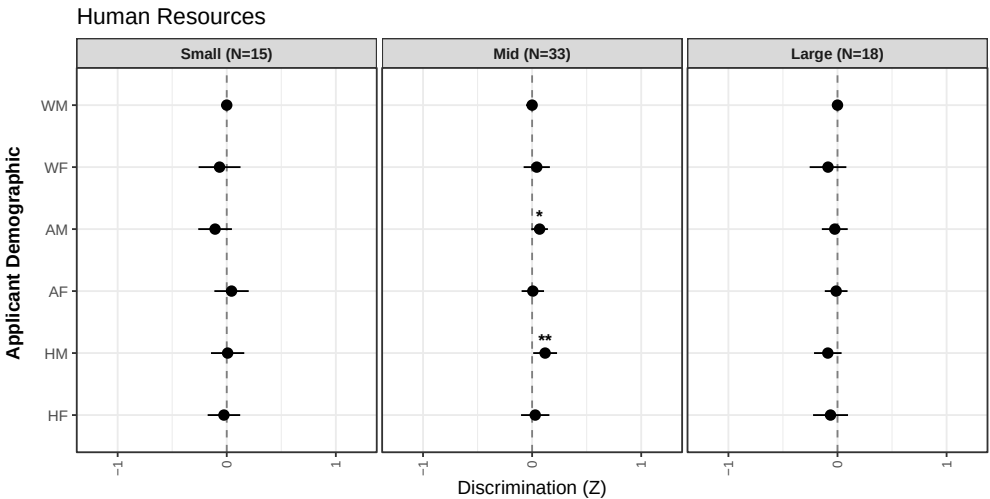
### Fit (Z) by Firm Size



### Stay (Z) by Firm Size



Advance (0/1, LPM) by Firm Size



Engineers: Not Measured

\*\*\*  $p < 0.01$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*  $p < 0.10$